The Hindu
EDITORIAL ANALYSIS

13th January 2025

PREPARE FOR BANK (PO/ CLERK), SSC,UPSC, State PSC, CAT,CTET,RAILWAY EXAMS,CDS, TET, NDA/AIRFORCE, NET and all Govt. Exams

VOCABULARY

1. Undermining (कमजोर करना)

Meaning: The act of weakening or damaging something, especially authority or confidence.
Synonyms: Weakening, sabotaging, impairing
Antonyms: Strengthening, supporting, bolstering
Example: His actions were seen as undermining the credibility of the committee.

2. Penchant (रुझान)

Meaning: A strong or habitual liking for something or tendency to do something.
Synonyms: Liking, preference, inclination
Antonyms: Dislike, aversion, antipathy
Example: She has a penchant for collecting rare books.

VOCABULARY

3. Debarment (प्रतिबंध)

Meaning: The act of officially preventing someone from doing something.
Synonyms: Exclusion, prohibition, barring
Antonyms: Allowance, permission, inclusion
Example: His debarment from the competition was due to unethical practices.

4. Pragmatic (व्यावहारिक)

Meaning: Dealing with things sensibly and realistically in a way that is based on practical considerations.
Synonyms: Practical, realistic, sensible
Antonyms: Idealistic, impractical, unrealistic
Example: The manager took a pragmatic approach to solve the issue.

VOCABULARY

5. Fatigue (थकावट)

Meaning: Extreme tiredness resulting from mental or physical exertion or illness.
Synonyms: Exhaustion, weariness, tiredness
Antonyms: Energy, vitality, vigor
Example: The long journey left them in a state of fatigue.

6. Cumbersome (भारी और कठिन)

Meaning: Large or heavy and therefore difficult to carry or use; unwieldy.
Synonyms: Awkward, unwieldy, clumsy
Antonyms: Convenient, manageable, light
Example: The process was so cumbersome that many people gave up halfway through.

VOCABULARY

7. Obliterate (नष्ट करना)

Meaning: To destroy completely; to wipe out.
Synonyms: Annihilate, erase, exterminate
Antonyms: Preserve, restore, construct
Example: The war obliterated entire villages, leaving nothing behind.

8. Stifling (दमघोंटू)

Meaning: Making it difficult to breathe or causing a feeling of suffocation; suppressing.
Synonyms: Oppressive, suffocating, constraining
Antonyms: Liberating, encouraging, invigorating
Example: The stifling heat made it impossible to concentrate.

VOCABULARY

9. Accentuate (जोर देना)

Meaning: To make something more noticeable or prominent.
Synonyms: Emphasize, highlight, underline
Antonyms: Downplay, minimize, de-emphasize
Example: The lighting accentuated the beauty of the painting.

10. Overwhelming (अत्यधिक)

Meaning: Very intense; too great to deal with.
Synonyms: Staggering, overpowering, massive.
Antonyms: Insignificant, trivial, negligible.
Example: The overwhelming support for the candidate ensured his victory.

VOCABULARY

Phrasal Verbs:

1. Winnow down:
Meaning: To narrow down or reduce something, often by eliminating unnecessary elements.

2. Nail down:
Meaning: To secure a specific decision, agreement, or understanding; to finalize something.

3. Sort through:
Meaning: To examine a collection of items or information to organize or find something specific.

4. Jack up:
Meaning: To increase something significantly, often abruptly, such as prices or rates.

VOCABULARY

Idioms & Phrases

1. On one’s toes

Meaning: ready for any eventuality; alert

2. Green with envy

Meaning: to be very jealous, envious

3. Lose one’s touch

Meaning: to stop communicating with someone

VOCABULARY

4. Once and for all

Meaning: now and for the last time

5. Easy as ABC

Meaning: extremely easy or straightforward

Article for Reading

India’s data protection rules need some fine-tuning

On January 3, 2025, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) released the much-anticipated Draft Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Rules — a key moment in India's journey to regulate digital personal data. This step follows the passage of the DPDP Act, 2023, bringing India closer to operationalising its framework for safeguarding personal data. The draft rules represent a departure from the earlier and controversial Personal Data Protection Bill, which many deemed was overly restrictive and even hostile to industry interests. The Bill underwent extensive framing, reframing and consultations over nearly a decade, only to be rescinded when committees and government stakeholders wisely decided it was untenable. In contrast, the positive response to the DPDP Act and its accompanying rules, reflected in conversations with businesses and in media coverage, stems from the less prescriptive, principles-based approach of the draft rules.

Unlike the earlier rush to regulate under the so-called “Brussels Effect”, where global digital rulemaking mirrored the European Union (EU)’s interventionist regulatory ethos, India has taken a more pragmatic stance. The EU’s General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), once hailed as a gold standard by privacy experts, now faces criticism for unintended consequences — favouring well-resourced corporations, stifling smaller enterprises, and failing to significantly enhance public trust in the Internet. India’s measured approach thus far offers a refreshing alternative to Europe’s interventionist policies. One of the draft rules’ standout features is their principles-based framework for notice and consent. While the GDPR has cumbersome requirements, such as notifying users of indirect data acquisition, cross-border data transfers, and automated decision-making processes, India’s rules emphasise simplicity and clarity. This helps reduce “consent fatigue”, a significant issue in Europe, where users are inundated with unnecessary details, such as the location of data processing — information of little practical use.

In 2023, the European Commission introduced the Cookie Pledge Initiative to address growing frustration over incessant consent pop-ups. However, such course correction would have been unnecessary had the EU taken a less invasive approach to regulating user interfaces and consent mechanisms. The very existence of this pledge highlights the burdens created by prescriptive regulation. India's DPDP Rules sidestep these pitfalls by focusing on outcomes rather than processes, empowering users without drowning businesses and consumers in unnecessary complexities. The rules avoid dictating how entities should enable users to exercise their rights to correction, erasure, nomination, withdrawal of consent and to seek information from entities. They require only the publication of relevant information on apps and websites. In contrast, the GDPR is prescriptive about how similar information should be presented, including instances where entities may need to provide this information orally to users.

Summary

The passage discusses the release of India's Draft Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Rules by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology on January 3, 2025. These rules represent a significant step in India’s data regulation journey, marking a shift from the controversial Personal Data Protection Bill and adopting a principles-based approach rather than the prescriptive regulatory ethos seen in the EU’s GDPR. The DPDP rules focus on simplicity, clarity, and user empowerment while avoiding excessive regulatory burdens like those associated with the GDPR, which has faced criticism for its unintended consequences, such as disadvantaging smaller enterprises and causing "consent fatigue." India’s approach emphasizes outcomes over processes, sidestepping complexities and focusing on user-friendly regulations, contrasting with the EU’s interventionist policies.

The tone is analytical and optimistic, highlighting the pragmatic and balanced nature of India's regulatory framework compared to the EU's more prescriptive approach. It reflects a sense of approval for India's less invasive and more adaptable principles-based model while critiquing the shortcomings of the GDPR.

Reading Comprehension

Based on the above passage, answer the following questions:

Question 1:
Which of the following challenges associated with the GDPR does the passage highlight?

a) It lacks provisions for cross-border data transfers.
b) It complicates user consent mechanisms, causing consent fatigue.
c) It excludes smaller enterprises from regulatory obligations.
d) It imposes lenient penalties for data privacy violations.
e) None of the above

Question 2:
Why does the passage describe India’s approach to digital data protection as "refreshing"?

a) It fully aligns with the GDPR framework while incorporating local nuances.
b) It eliminates user consent requirements entirely.
c) It introduces stricter compliance mechanisms for businesses.
d) It avoids mimicking the interventionist policies of the EU.
e) None of the above

Question 3:
How do the DPDP Rules simplify the exercise of user rights compared to the GDPR?

a) By eliminating all requirements for data correction and erasure.
b) By mandating oral communication of user rights to entities.
c) By requiring entities to publish relevant information online without dictating presentation methods.
d) By removing the need for users to provide consent for data processing.
e) None of the above

Article for Skimming

Centralising control: on the Draft UGC Regulations, 2025

In a federal setup, attempts at undermining any stakeholder in the subject matter of education, which is in the Concurrent List, will prove disruptive. The Draft UGC (Minimum Qualifications for Appointment and Promotion of Teachers and Academic Staff in Universities and Colleges and Measures for the Maintenance of Standards in Higher Education) Regulations, 2025, seeks to do precisely this. Demonstrating the Centre's penchant for facilitating control over institutions through gubernatorial proxies, it proposes to divest State governments of their role in the selection process for Vice Chancellor (VC) of universities. All powers are sought to be vested in the Chancellor — i.e., the Governor in most State universities — by taking away the function of constituting the search-cum-selection committee from the higher education departments. Such a committee would comprise a nominee each of the Chancellor; UGC Chairman; and of the respective university syndicate/senate.

The Chancellor would appoint the VC out of three to five names recommended by the committee. Any violations, the draft warns, could attract debarment from participating in UGC schemes and denial of funding under the UGC Act. This comes against the backdrop of conflicts between State governments and Raj Bhavans on appointing VCs, which have deprived several universities, particularly in Tamil Nadu, of leadership. Naturally, opposition has come from several States, including Tamil Nadu, which passed a House resolution urging the Centre to immediately withdraw the draft. Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M.K. Stalin has argued that the draft is not only against the basic federal principles enshrined in the Constitution but also poses a threat to the higher education system. Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan, the AIADMK and the CPI-M have endorsed this stance. A proposal to make non-academics eligible for the VC's job has also drawn criticism.

The draft says such non-academics must have served for at least 10 years at a senior level in industry, public administration, public policy and/or public sector undertakings, with a proven track record of significant academic or scholarly contributions. Mr. Vijayan fears this could be used to appoint Sangh Parivar loyalists. However, universities have benefited from the scholarship of non-academics such as former President K.R. Narayanan and scientist Y. Nayudamma; appointing academics does not guarantee visionary leadership. The proposal to extend the VC's tenure from the typical three to five years is welcome. The UGC would do well to remove anti-federal clauses from the draft regulations and allay apprehensions on other provisions. In the long run, it should aim for reforms to obliterate any governmental role in university administration, except maybe, for funding, and elevate them into truly autonomous institutions that nurture excellence.

Question 4:
What has been one of the main arguments by Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M.K. Stalin against the draft regulations?

a) It undermines the federal structure of the Constitution.
b) It imposes an arbitrary selection process for university professors.
c) It excludes non-academics from holding leadership positions.
d) It mandates State universities to follow national curricula.
e) None of the above

Question 5:
Why has the proposal to make non-academics eligible for the VC position drawn criticism?

a) It disregards the experience of academic scholars.
b) It risks the appointment of individuals aligned with particular ideological groups.
c) It fails to specify criteria for non-academic eligibility.
d) It mandates non-academics to have served at least 15 years in public service.
e) None of the above

Today's Descriptive Question:

- **Write an essay of 200 words about the effects of screen time on child development.**

Excessive screen time has significant effects on child development, impacting physical, cognitive, and social aspects. Physically, prolonged screen exposure often leads to a sedentary lifestyle, which can increase the risk of obesity and other health issues. Children who spend hours in front of screens may also experience eye strain and disrupted sleep patterns due to blue light exposure, which can impair their overall health and growth.

Cognitively, excessive screen time may hinder critical development stages. Young children need hands-on, interactive experiences to build problem-solving skills and foster creativity, yet passive consumption of screen content can delay these processes. Studies have shown that children with high screen exposure often perform lower in areas like language, memory, and attention compared to peers with limited screen time.

Socially, screen dependency can impede essential interpersonal skills. Children who spend more time on screens may have less time for face-to-face interactions, limiting opportunities to develop empathy, communication, and conflict-resolution skills. Additionally, excessive screen time can contribute to behavioral issues, as children may become more irritable or withdrawn without their devices.

To promote healthy development, a balanced approach that includes adequate screen-free time is crucial, allowing children to explore the world actively and build meaningful relationships.

- **Write a letter to your friend describing a place that you have visited recently.**

[Your Address]
[City, Zip Code]
[Date]

Dear [Friend's Name],

I hope you're well! I recently visited [Place Name], and I thought of you the whole time. The place was beautiful – surrounded by lush greenery and peaceful views. I visited [specific attraction or landmark] and was amazed by the breathtaking scenery. The local food, especially [mention a dish], was delicious, and the people were incredibly warm and welcoming.

I know you'd love the vibe here; maybe we can plan a trip together someday!
Take care,
[Your Name]

Match the column

1. On one’s toes	A. to stop communicating with someone
2. Green with envy	B. now and for the last time
3. Lose one’s touch	C. ready for any eventuality; alert
4. Once and for all	D. extremely easy or straightforward
5. Easy as ABC	E. to be very jealous, envious.

Answer:

1-c

2-e

3-a

4-b

5-d

Vocabulary

1. Undermining:
2. Penchant:
3. Debarment:
4. Pragmatic:
5. Fatigue:
6. Cumbersome:
7. Obliterate:
8. Stifling:
9. Accentuate:
10. Overwhelming:

Rc ans

1.

Ans: b

Explanation:

The passage discusses how the GDPR’s prescriptive requirements, such as notifying users of indirect data acquisition and cross-border data transfers, lead to “consent fatigue” by overwhelming users with unnecessary details.

Reference:

"...helps reduce ‘consent fatigue’, a significant issue in Europe, where users are inundated with unnecessary details."

Incorrect Options:

a) The GDPR includes provisions for cross-border data transfers.

c) It favors larger corporations but does not exclude smaller enterprises from obligations.

d) The passage does not discuss GDPR penalties.

2.

Ans: d

Explanation:

India’s DPDP Rules take a pragmatic stance, avoiding the overly prescriptive, interventionist regulatory ethos of the GDPR, which has faced criticism for its unintended consequences.

Reference:

"India has taken a more pragmatic stance... offers a refreshing alternative to Europe’s interventionist policies."

Incorrect Options:

a) India’s approach diverges from the GDPR framework.

b) User consent requirements are simplified, not eliminated.

c) The DPDP Rules are less stringent than the GDPR.

3.
Ans: c
Explanation:
The DPDP Rules require entities to publish relevant information about user rights but avoid prescribing how this information should be presented, unlike the GDPR.

Reference:
"...they require only the publication of relevant information on apps and websites... In contrast, the GDPR is prescriptive about how similar information should be presented."

Incorrect Options:

a) User rights are simplified, not eliminated.
b) Oral communication is not a requirement under the DPDP Rules.
d) User consent is still required but simplified.

4.
Ans: a
Explanation:
M.K. Stalin has argued that the draft regulations violate the federal principles enshrined in the Constitution by centralizing control over VC appointments.

Reference:
"Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M.K. Stalin has argued that the draft is not only against the basic federal principles enshrined in the Constitution..."

Incorrect Options:

b) The draft focuses on VC appointments, not professor selection.
c) The draft allows non-academics to hold leadership roles.
d) The draft does not discuss national curricula.

5.
Ans: b
Explanation:
The Kerala Chief Minister has raised concerns that the provision could be exploited to appoint individuals with ideological affiliations, such as those aligned with the Sangh Parivar.

Reference:
"Mr. Vijayan fears this could be used to appoint Sangh Parivar loyalists."

Incorrect Options:

a) The draft does not disregard academics; it allows for both academics and non-academics.
c) Criteria for non-academic eligibility are specified.
d) The required experience is 10 years, not 15.

NIMISHA BANSAL

EXCLUSIVE SUBSCRIPTION

- ACCESS TO ALL COURSES (PERFECTION, GRAMMAR GRANTH, ERRORS
- Live+ Recorded Sessions
- Class PDF's
- Basic To Advance level
- Best Courses Till Date

Price : ~~₹ 2499~~
₹

USE CODE _____

yes OFFICER

PREMIUM SUBSCRIPTION

ALL EDUCATOR COURSES

ALL BANK EXAM 2024 PRELIMS+MAINS

ENGLISH

QUANT

REASONING

GENERAL AWARENESS

FOUNDATION + HIGH LEVEL COURSES

USE CODE

JOIN TELEGRAM CHANNEL

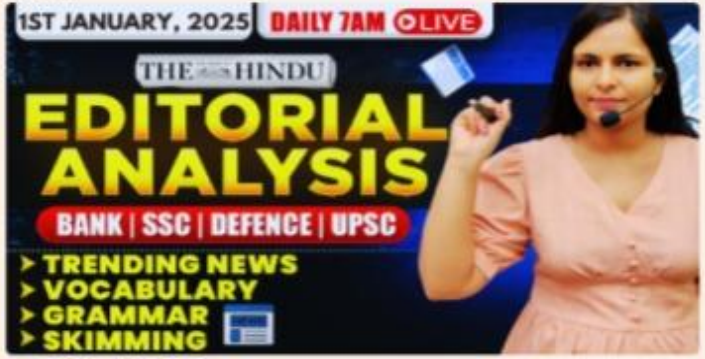
ENGLISH WITH NIMISHA BANSAL

@NimishaMam

English with Nimisha Bansal
452 824 subscribers

YouTube
Editorial Analysis | 1st January, 2025 | Vocab, Grammar, Reading, Skimming | Nimisha Bansal
Editorial Analysis | 1st January, 2025 | Vocab, Grammar, Reading, Skimming | Nimisha Bansal

✅One Premium Subscription
USE CODE - SAFALTA
https...



30K 08:00

Perfection Class: Debunking English Grammar Myths I Perfection I

CONTENT - NIMISHA BANSAL

@mamnimisha

Content- Nimisha Bansal
174 346 subscribers

annotation 1st Jan 2025 2.6K 13:37

Forwarded from
English with Nimisha Bansal
Perfection_Clas...t_Jan_2025.pdf
3.1 MB
Perfection Class Error detection with annotation 1st Jan 2025 2.9K 13:37

Forwarded from
English with Nimisha Bansal
PERFECTION CLA...T January.pdf
34.1 MB
PERFECTION CLASS NOTES 1K 14:14

Forwarded from
English with Nimisha Bansal
EDITORIAL VOC...UARY 2025.pdf
2.7 MB
EDITORIAL VOCAB 1ST JANUARY 2025 1K 14:14